

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Koteswar Rao Modepalli

Address: 18 Brasted Close Sutton SM2 5BE

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:

1. Additional Traffic in an Already Busy Area

The location around the Avenue school is already heavily used at key times of the day, particularly mornings and afternoons. Introducing a large community use building here will bring further traffic to an area that struggles with flow and visibility. This raises concerns about congestion and the ability of the road network to cope safely.

2. Parking Demand Exceeding Capacity

The proposal appears to underestimate the number of vehicles that such a facility would attract. As a result, there is a strong likelihood that visitors will park on nearby residential roads when the onsite provision is full. This will add pressure to streets that already experience difficulty due to Avenue school related parking.

3. Noise Generated by Increased Activity

A premises designed for regular group use is likely to produce noise from large numbers of arrivals and departures. This includes engine noise, conversations, and general movement. These repeated disturbances would be particularly noticeable during evenings, weekends, or special events, affecting the tranquillity of nearby homes.

4. Negative Effect on Residents' Daily Living

The continuous comings and goings associated with the proposed facility would alter the character of the surrounding residential area. Residents could experience reduced privacy, more foot traffic outside their homes, and a general increase in day to day disruption. These effects would materially impact the comfort and enjoyment of their properties.

5. Combined Pressure with Existing Avenue School Activities

The school already creates predictable periods of intense use, with parents, students, and staff generating significant activity at certain times. Adding another destination with its own peaks of attendance could result in overlapping pressure on both the road network and local parking. This cumulative impact has not been adequately addressed within the application.

6. Light Pollution and Impact on the Surrounding Area

The proposal is likely to introduce additional external lighting for security, access, and evening activities. Increased artificial light, particularly during darker hours, may spill into neighbouring gardens and homes, reducing residents' ability to enjoy their outdoor spaces and affecting sleep patterns. Bright or prolonged lighting can also disrupt local wildlife by interfering with natural daynight cycles, particularly for birds, insects, and nocturnal mammals. Without a detailed lighting strategy, it is unclear how the development will prevent glare, overspill, or unnecessary illumination of the surrounding residential environment.

7. Pressure on Local Infrastructure and Services

The proposed development could place additional strain on the surrounding infrastructure, including local roads, pedestrian pathways, and public spaces. These facilities are already heavily used by school families and residents, particularly at peak times. An increase in visitor numbers may accelerate wear on pavements, create higher maintenance needs, and reduce the overall capacity of shared community spaces. Without a clear assessment of how these impacts will be managed, the proposal risks overstressing infrastructure that is already functioning close to its limits.

8. Increased Pressure on Waste Collection and Refuse Management

The proposal is likely to generate a higher volume of waste than is currently produced in the area, particularly during events or busy periods. Without a clear, detailed wastemanagement plan, there is a risk that refuse bins may overflow or accumulate around the site. This can lead to unpleasant odours, attract pests, and create visual clutter within a residential setting. Additionally, increased waste output may require more frequent collection, which in turn could add noise, vehicle movements, and disruption for nearby homes.